

Moral and Social Philosophy of Islam:

The Concept of Good and Evil

Introduction

- ❑ In Islam, good and evil are defined by Allah's divine wisdom, surpassing human perception, which can be limited or misleading.
- ❑ The Qur'an emphasizes that only Allah determines what is truly good or bad.
- ❑ Good brings a person closer to Allah and benefits them in the Hereafter, while evil distances them and incurs His displeasure.
- ❑ The purpose of life is to achieve spiritual perfection through faith, knowledge, love, and worship of Allah.

Why do we have to practice الأمر بالمعروف والنهي عن المنكر؟

- 1. Gratitude for Guidance** – Just as we appreciate someone warning us about a dishonest shopkeeper or a doctor informing us about harmful substances, we should be even more thankful to those who guide us in matters of life and the Hereafter.
- 2. Prophetic Mission** – Calling to good and stopping evil is the mission of the Prophets. The Prophet ﷺ said: “Whoever calls to guidance will have a reward similar to the reward of those who follow him.” (Saheeh Muslim)
- 3. Preventing Corruption** – If people neglect enjoining good and forbidding evil, wrongdoing will spread, leading to widespread corruption, as warned in the Qur'an: [So, because of the transgression of those who became Jews, We prohibited for them good things which were made lawful for them earlier...And their taking of Riba' though they were forbidden from taking it]. (4:160).
- 4. Collective Responsibility** – The Ummah is one body, and it is a duty upon all to reform and advise one another for the well-being of the community.

What if?

◉ What if our Prophet ﷺ accepted the offer of Quraish of not condemning their gods, and minding his own business?

Necessity and Importance of Invitation Towards Deen

You are the best nation produced [as an example] for mankind. You enjoin what is right and forbid what is wrong and believe in Allah. If only the People of the Scripture had believed, it would have been better for them. Among them are believers, but most of them are defiantly disobedient.

كُنْتُمْ خَيْرَ أُمَّةٍ أُخْرِجَتْ
لِلنَّاسِ تَأْمُرُونَ بِالْمَعْرُوفِ
وَتَنْهَوْنَ عَنِ الْمُنْكَرِ
وَتُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَلَوْ آمَنَ
أَهْلُ الْكِتَابِ لَكَانَ خَيْرًا
لَّهُمْ مِنْهُمْ الْمُؤْمِنُونَ
وَأَكْثَرُهُمْ فَاسِقُونَ ﴿١١٠﴾
(آل عمران: 110).

Important lessons from this Aayah

- Umar bin Al-Khattab رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ – recited this Ayah during Hajj, he then said: “Whoever likes to be among this praised Ummah, let him fulfill the condition that Allah set in this Ayah”.
- Allah says: “Thus, We have made you a just (and the best) nation” (2:143). means one that represents a middle path between exaggeration and negligence.
- Towards the end of this verse, it has been said about the People of the Book that there are some Muslims among them. This refers to those who confirmed the prophet hood of Muhammad صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ such as Abdullah ibn Salaam رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ – and others.

Modern day issues which requires awareness

- 1) **The increasing prevalence of interest-based transactions.**
- 2) **Purchasing homes through mortgages.**
- 3) **The complexities of various types of insurance.**
- 4) **The growing influence of social media and entertainment industries.**

Remember! They Are Not Just for Entertainment!

They shape perceptions and influence behavior by:

- 1) **Promoting Materialism:** Glamorizing wealth, fame, and a false sense of success.
- 2) **Triggering Desires:** Encouraging unrestricted interactions, normalizing immorality, and spreading trans-cultural influences.
- 3) **Wasting Time & Encouraging Laziness:** Leading to dishonesty, self-obsession, and ignorance.
- 4) **Misrepresenting Islam:** Distorting Islamic values and spreading misconceptions.

How to Invite to the path of Allah سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى؟

- Invite to the way of your Lord with wisdom and beautiful preaching and argue with them in a way that is best. Indeed, your Lord is most knowing of who has strayed from His way, and He is most knowing of who is [rightly] guided.

﴿ اَدْعُ إِلَى سَبِيلِ رَبِّكَ
بِالْحُكْمَةِ وَالْمَوْعِظَةِ
الْحَسَنَةِ وَجَادِلْهُمْ
بِالَّتِي هِيَ أَحْسَنُ إِنَّ
رَبَّكَ هُوَ أَعْلَمُ بِمَنْ
عَنْ سَبِيلِهِ وَهُوَ ضَلَّ
أَعْلَمُ بِالْمُهْتَدِينَ ﴾
(النحل: 125).

(ادْعُ إِلَى) **Invite all:** Let your calling be for all, whether they are Muslims or non-Muslims, to the straight path of your Lord that includes beneficial knowledge and righteous deeds.

(بِالْحِكْمَةِ) **Wisdom:** Call people according to their condition and level of understanding.

□ It is wise to invite with knowledge, beginning with the most important and what is easiest to grasp.

(وَالْمَوْعِظَةِ الْحَسَنَةِ) **Effective advice:** Command and prohibition along with encouragement and intimidation.

(وَجَادِلْهُمْ) **and debate with them:** If the above ways are not effective then argue with them in the best manner, with the rational and emotional methods.

□ Since the Prophet صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ, faced harm from the polytheists, which might cause him to be harsh with them in giving da'wah, Allah commanded him to argue with them in the best manner.

Qualities of One Who Enjoins Good and Forbids Evil

- 1) **Ikhlās (Sincerity)** – This duty should be performed solely for the sake of Allah, seeking His pleasure, not for personal gain or recognition. Actions done with sincerity are accepted by Him.
- 2) **Ilm (Knowledge)** – as Allah commands: “Say: This is my path; I do call to Allah upon clear knowledge”.
- 3) **Hikmah (Wisdom)** – This means conveying the message in the best way, at the right time, in the right manner, to the right person.
- 4) **Hilm (Forbearance)** – Remaining calm and composed, especially in the face of opposition, criticism, or resistance.
- 5) **Sabr (Patience)** - A person came to Prophet ﷺ and spoke that he will only pray two prayers, Prophet ﷺ accepted. (مسند أحمد)
 - Some people from Saqeef said: we will accept Islam but will not go to Jihad and will not give you charity so Prophet ﷺ accepted and said: (once they will enter Islam, they will do all of it). (أبو داود)
- 6) **Tawaadu' (Humility)** Advising others without arrogance, recognizing one's own shortcomings, and avoiding self-righteousness.

Moral and Social Philosophy of Islam:

AKHLAQ-E-HASANA

with reference to Surah Al-Hujraat

(Aayaat 10-13)

Islamic Morals

- ▶ Allah **سُبْحَانَهُ وَتَعَالَى** has prescribed various acts of worship that bring a person closer to Him. The Prophet **صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ** said, **"There is nothing heavier on the believer's scale on the Day of Judgment than good character"** (Tirmidhi).
- ▶ Good morals elevate one's status, as he also said, **"A believer can reach the level of someone who fasts and prays by having good character"** (Abu Dawood).
- ▶ Even small acts of kindness are rewarded, **"Do not belittle any good deed, even smiling at your brother"** (Muslim).
- ▶ Good character is among the top reasons for entering Paradise (Tirmidhi).
- ▶ Those with the best character will be closest to the Prophet **صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ** on the Day of Judgment (Tirmidhi).

SURAH AL-HUJRAAT

- Chapter 49 of the Holy Qur'ān, Surah Al-Ḥujrāt with 18 verses, focuses primarily on civility and good manners. It begins with five verses advising Muslims to show respect for the Prophet (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَعَلَى آلِهِ وَسَلَّمَ) a principle that can be extended to include respect for all Muslim leaders.
- Additionally, the chapter addresses the Muslim community as one family, it has been told what attitude should the other Muslims adopt in case two groups of the Muslims fall to mutual fighting.
- It further provides guidance on actions that lead to the integrity and prosperity of this family.

Making Peace between Disputing Muslims

• ﴿إِنَّمَا الْمُؤْمِنُونَ إِخْوَةٌ فَأَصْلَحُوا بَيْنَ أَخَوَيْكُمْ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ لَعَلَّكُمْ تُرْحَمُونَ﴾ [الحجرات:

[10]

- “The believers are brothers, so reconcile between your brothers, and remain conscious of Allah, so that you may receive mercy”.

In the Light of the Aayah

- 1.** Brotherhood of Islam does not disappear with the presence of dispute/fight, Allah has commanded us to give preference to the Islamic Unity.
- 2.** “المؤمنون” This is a contract, and it includes the people of the East and the West.
- 3.** One of the rights of brotherhood in faith is reconciliation between disputants and avoiding what hurts feelings.

Essentials of Respect & Dignity in Human Relationships

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا يَسْخَرُ قَوْمٌ مِنْ قَوْمٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونَ خَيْرًا مِنْهُمْ وَلَا نِسَاءٌ مِنْ نِسَاءٍ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَكُونَ خَيْرًا مِنْهُنَّ وَلَا تَلْمِزُوا أَنْفُسَكُمْ وَلَا تَنَابَزُوا بِالْأَلْقَابِ بِئْسَ الْأَسْمُ الْفُسُوقُ بَعْدَ الْإِيمَانِ وَمَنْ لَمْ يَتُبْ فَأُولَٰئِكَ هُمُ الظَّالِمُونَ، يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اجْتَنِبُوا كَثِيرًا مِّنَ الظَّنِّ إِنَّ بَعْضَ الظَّنِّ إِثْمٌ وَلَا تَجَسَّسُوا وَلَا يَغْتَبِ بَعْضُكُم بَعْضًا أَيُحِبُّ أَحَدُكُمْ أَنْ يَأْكُلَ لَحْمَ أَخِيهِ مَيْتًا فَكَرِهْتُمُوهُ وَاتَّقُوا اللَّهَ إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَوَّابٌ رَّحِيمٌ﴾
(الحجرات: 12-11).

“O you who believe! No people shall ridicule other people, for they may be better than they. Nor shall any women ridicule other women, for they may be better than they. And do not insult one another and do not call each other by [offensive] nicknames. Evil is the return to wickedness after having attained faith. And whosoever does not repent, then such are indeed wrongdoers.

O you who believe! Avoid most suspicion, for indeed some suspicion is sinful. And do not spy, nor backbite one another. Would any of you like to eat the flesh of his dead brother? You would detest it. And fear Allāh; indeed, Allah is most acceptor of Repentance, most Merciful”.

In the Light of the Aayah

- There can be two reasons for mockery: having a religious or ideological disagreement or treating the other as inferior and contemptible. In any case, it is likely to lead to fights, thus it is Haram.
- (الْلَمَزُ) To blame through words, (الْهَمَزُ) To blame through actions.
- One who does not repent and persists in disobedience and sins is considered an oppressor.
- Hadith: “Beware of suspicion, for suspicion is the falsest of speech. Do not seek out one another’s faults; do not spy on one another; do not compete with one another; do not envy one another; do not hate one another; do not turn away from one another. Be, O slaves of Allah, brothers.” **Al-Bukhari (5144) and Muslim (2563, 4917).**

Law of Equality:

﴿يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ إِنَّا خَلَقْنَاكُمْ مِنْ ذَكَرٍ وَأُنْثَىٰ وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا إِنَّ أَكْرَمَكُمْ عِنْدَ اللَّهِ أَتْقَاكُمْ إِنَّ اللَّهَ عَلِيمٌ خَبِيرٌ﴾ (الحجرات: 13).

O mankind, indeed We have created you from male and female and made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allāh is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allāh is Knowing and Aware.

In the Light of the Verse

- Islam does not pay attention to differences in color, race or lineage. All people are children of Adam, and Adam was created from dust.
- The purpose behind making humankind into nations and tribes is so that they may know one another. Origins and lineage serve to identify individuals and fulfill rights and duties based on blood ties. However, they should not be used to claim superiority over others.
- According to Islam, superiority of some people over others is measured by faith and taqwa (piety, mindfulness of Allah).
- ❑ Sayyidna Abdullah Ibn Abbas رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُمَا says: 'For people, "honor" lies in wealth, whilst in the sight of Allah it lies in righteousness'.
- There were some of the Sahabah who were not Arabs, such as Salman al Farsi (who was Persian), Bilal al-Habashi (who was Ethiopian), Umm Ayman Barakah al-Habashiyyah (who was Ethiopian), Zinnirah ar-Roomiyyah (who was Byzantinian) and others.